

ACTIVITY 4 — FACILITATOR GUIDE

Digital Reputation Audit Exercise

TYPE	DURATION	MAPS TO	TOPIC
Case Study	45 minutes	LU1	LU1 — Stakeholders and Organisation

Purpose of this activity

By the end of this activity learners will be able to assess the organisation's reputation on social media and other platforms (LU1).

What learners produce

A reputation report: three platforms, a sentiment breakdown per platform, three named recurring themes, and one response action per theme.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- The course slides for the scenario and framework
- Internet access where the activity calls for live research

Set-up

Groups of 3–5. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group. All 17 activities run on the same continuous Nimbus Wellness scenario, so remind learners of where this activity sits in that story before you start.

Scenario / briefing material

Six months ago a competitor's viral campaign pulled attention away from Nimbus Wellness. Since then, engagement has fallen and reviews increasingly say the brand "doesn't feel personal anymore."

Before the founder finalises the relaunch brief, leadership wants a clear-eyed audit of where Nimbus's reputation actually stands today — not where the founder assumes it stands.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Choose three platforms and justify each. Pick the three platforms most likely to reveal genuine customer feeling about Nimbus — typically one review platform, one social platform, and	This is the longest activity (45 min) — hold tables to the clock at the coding stage, which is where groups over-run.

	one marketplace or retailer listing. Write one line per platform on why it earns a place. Choosing where your brand is most flattered is the wrong instinct.	
2	Define your sentiment coding rules before you read. Agree what counts as positive, neutral and negative BEFORE sampling — otherwise the coding drifts. A useful rule: negative = would discourage a prospective buyer; neutral = factual with no recommendation either way; positive = would encourage.	If a table reports overwhelmingly positive sentiment, check their sample: they have usually sampled the brand's own channels, where critics are least present.
3	Sample recent mentions. Take the most recent 10–15 mentions or reviews per platform from the supplied pack. Recency matters more than volume: you are auditing where reputation stands today, not its all-time average.	The best leadership summaries lead with the gap, not the data.
4	Code each mention. Tag every sampled mention positive, neutral or negative, and note the phrase that decided it. Those phrases are your raw material for the next step.	
5	Tally the sentiment split per platform. Produce a simple percentage breakdown per platform. Then compare it against what the founder currently believes. Name the gap explicitly — that gap is the finding leadership most needs.	
6	Cluster into recurring themes. Group the phrases you recorded into themes. Push past the surface complaint to the cause: “doesn't feel personal anymore” usually decomposes into slower replies, templated responses, or a loss of founder voice. Name exactly three themes.	
7	Write one response action per theme. Each action must be specific, owned and doable — name what happens, who does it, and by when. “Improve communication” is not an action; “reply to all reviews within 48 hours, owned by Customer Service, from Monday” is.	
8	Assemble the leadership summary. One page: the three platforms with sentiment splits, the three themes, the three actions, and one sentence on the single highest-priority action before the relaunch brief is finalised.	

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
5 min	Scope the audit: choose and justify three platforms
12 min	Sample and code recent mentions by sentiment
12 min	Cluster the coded mentions into recurring themes
10 min	Write one response action per theme
6 min	Assemble the leadership-ready summary

Total: 45 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. Which three platforms will actually reveal how customers feel about Nimbus right now — and why those three?
2. Looking at a sample of recent mentions and reviews, what recurring themes sit behind "doesn't feel personal anymore"?
3. How would you categorise the balance of positive, neutral and negative sentiment — and does it match what the founder currently believes?
4. What is the single highest-priority response action leadership should take before the relaunch brief is finalised?

Debrief

Bring the class back together and draw out the learning:

- Ask two or three groups to show what they produced, not just what they concluded.
- Ask what surprised them — the gap between what they assumed and what they found.
- Link the activity explicitly back to LU1 — Stakeholders and Organisation.
- Remind learners this activity rehearses what the Case Study assessment will require.

Reflection questions:

- Did the sentiment split match what you expected before you actually read the reviews?
- Which recurring theme was hardest to reduce to one line for a leadership summary?
- If "doesn't feel personal anymore" kept appearing after the relaunch too, what would that tell you about the relaunch plan itself?

Facilitator notes — what to watch for

- This is the longest activity (45 min) — hold tables to the clock at the coding stage, which is where groups over-run.
- If a table reports overwhelmingly positive sentiment, check their sample: they have usually sampled the brand's own channels, where critics are least present.
- The best leadership summaries lead with the gap, not the data.

Success criterion

Every group can show a platform-by-platform sentiment breakdown, three named recurring themes, and one response action per theme leadership could act on this week.

Assessment link

This activity builds LU1 — Stakeholders and Organisation. All 17 activities are in-class activities assessed indirectly through the open-book Case Study (CS) component, which reuses the same

techniques on the same continuous Nimbus Wellness scenario. Knowledge is assessed in the Written Assessment (WA-SAQ). Nothing is assessed that is not practised here or taught in the slides.